that the entire experience was to be controlled by keyboard and mouse, or at best a controller, people got engulfed into it and soon there were reports of Second Life related crimes. Now think about AltspaceVR.

No, we are not telling you about some obscure keyboard shortcut to operate the Oculus Rift. AltspaceVR Inc is a company that is working on virtual presence and has advocated itself as an alternative to hour long drives or flights across the world just to see one PowerPoint. Although its initial demo was about virtual meetings, the company's website enlists games as well as a diverse array of gestures which might not necessarily be all about work. The whole experience is being designed to work with the current breed of VR products.

The Xbox Kinect camera, built using Primesense's camera technology, is already a representation of how motion detection is going to be.

What separates our current state with something right out of the "Surrogates" movie are two factors - detection and synthetic bodies. To replicate a human interaction completely, extremely accurate sensors to capture expressions, complete body movement need to be developed and even the senses of smell and taste need to be incorporated deeply into the Virtual Reality experience. Faceshift is a motion-detection studio that has developed a software which only requires you to record your expressions against your avatars' using a normal consumer level camera. Something on these lines but real-time will make your avatar's face come to life. And technology like Primesense's 3D sensing, which is used widely across several technology platforms, can detect the rest of the body and even the surrounding environment.

To achieve synthetic bodies which are accurate down to the microscopic level, we might literally have to go microscopic. Nanotechnology has helped us conceptualize robots that can essentially fulfil the role of atoms, giving us full control over material technology and allowing us to create any synthetic body that we desire, even an improved version of our own body. Even if we do not go down to that level of detail, the possibility